Indeed, as education levels improve in India, one can expect more high-skilled internal migration for higher studies and work, concentrated in a few urban centres. Restrictions on the migration of the highly skilled would be counter-productive and also reduce overall human welfare. As per one study, the ratio of patents filed by Indians in North America to that by Indians in India stood at a staggering 28,000:1.[33] Clearly, the productivity of Indians is highly dependent on enabling environments, whose provision would reduce the outflow of brains or even lead to a return of brains. Until then, there is considerable truth in an adage attributed to a member of India's Planning Commission that 'a brain drain is better than a brain in a drain.'[34]

There is, however, an alternative brain drain that is rarely talked about. This refers to the migration of high-skilled spouses, almost always women, who accompany the high-skilled migrant workers, but do not end up working for remuneration due to restrictions placed by families or visa regulations. Within India, this leads to a colossal under-utilization of talent as millions of female graduates forgo active professional careers upon their move to a new state or city, to look after children or the family. Outside India, visa restrictions on work for dependents can kill aspirations and dull the brains. In the USA, over a 1,00,000 Indian dependents live on the less-known H4 visa, known as the depression visa. Studies have shown how this brings about a loss of self-confidence and discomfort because of financial dependence on the spouse, even for remittances, and overall, retards professional careers due to the erosion of skills.[35] In such cases, the American sitcom *Desperate Housewives* offers only partial relief to the brain pain.

Trafficking and Female Flight

The gendered nature of the brain drain is only one of the many ways in which migration and gender are interlinked. The Great Indian Migration Wave was fundamentally a male-dominated mass migration stream with mixed implications for the women left behind. It did lead to greater female